STONEWARD CONSTRUCTION
Utah's ADU Experts

BACKYARD ADU
LOT CHECKLIST

What to check on every lot

Address: _____ City: _____ Date: _____

1. Does the lot qualify?

- [ ] Lot size is 11,000 sq ft or more (acres × 43,560). Size: _____
- [ ] A single-family home is on the lot, and single-family use is permitted in the zone
- [ ] City is covered by SB 284, and has adopted its detached ADU rules
- [ ] Zoning district: _____ . Any overlay or development agreement signed on or before 5/6/26?
- [ ] HOA or covenants checked: _____ (separate from city rules)
- [ ] Owner lives on site, or the city does not require it

2. City rules for this lot

- [ ] Max footprint: _____ . Is it also capped by the main home's footprint?
- [ ] Max height: _____ . Stories allowed: _____
- [ ] Setbacks: side ____ rear ____ street side (corner) ____ front yard not allowed?
- [ ] Distance required from the main house: _____ and from neighbors' homes: _____
- [ ] Accessory buildings together limited to ___% of the rear yard
- [ ] Not in a utility or other recorded easement
- [ ] Parking: 1 space under 650 sq ft, 2 at 650 sq ft or more. Where does it go?
- [ ] If converting a garage, is the lost parking replaced?
- [ ] Rental minimum (90 days) and any rental license or registration
- [ ] One ADU per lot, size vs main home, design must match main home?
- [ ] Impact fees and review path (planning committee, building permit)

3. Utilities

4. Site and foundation

- [ ] Slope where the unit will sit: ____ % . Grading or retaining walls needed?
- [ ] Foundation type: crawl space, slab or piers. Frost depth and soils known?
- [ ] Drainage and groundwater: where does water go?
- [ ] Trees, fences, sheds, pool or structures to remove or protect
- [ ] Existing structure to convert? Legally built, meets setbacks and codes?
- [ ] Sun, privacy, window orientation and the view from the main house

5. Crane and delivery access

- [ ] Where can the crane stand: street, driveway or side yard? (A built pad is not needed. Mats work on soft ground.)
- [ ] Reach: distance from the crane to the foundation center: ____ ft. Farther means a bigger crane
- [ ] No overhead power or communication lines in the swing path (utility shutoff needs notice)
- [ ] Delivery truck route: street width, turns, low trees, gates, slope
- [ ] Side-yard width and fence or tree removal needed: ____
- [ ] Staging area for the truck. Street or right-of-way permit needed?
- [ ] Neighbor permission if their driveway or alley is used

6. Plan fit

- [ ] Plan, length and width: _____ . Fits inside all setbacks, rotated either way?
- [ ] Under 650 sq ft for the lower parking rule?
- [ ] Entry path, porch and parking laid out on a sketch of the lot

- [ ] Sewer main location, depth and lateral. Distance to the unit: ____ ft
- [ ] Shared or separate sewer lateral allowed? Capacity letter needed?
- [ ] Septic or sewer? (Septic changes the budget and approval)
- [ ] Water main, meter size and line size. Separate meter required?
- [ ] Power company: city power or Rocky Mountain Power. Service size and panel space
- [ ] Meter rules (some cities limit meters) and overhead vs underground
- [ ] Gas line location, if used
- [ ] Pressurized irrigation or storm drain lines in the way
- [ ] Utility locate requested (Blue Stakes 811) before any dig plan is final
- [ ] Rough cost to run each utility to the unit: sewer ____ water ____ power ____
- [ ] Single-story or two-story, against the height limit

7. Money and goals

- [ ] Purpose: family, long-term rental or office. Income worksheet run
- [ ] Whole-project budget with 10% contingency. Financing lined up
- [ ] Utility and site costs priced before choosing the plan

8. Collect these

- [ ] Parcel number and lot map or plat, survey if the owner has one
- [ ] Photos of the front, back, both sides and the crane and truck approach
- [ ] HOA documents, deed or title, and any past permits
- [ ] City ordinance page and the date you checked it

Go / caution / no-go. No-go: lot under 11,000 sq ft and the city does not allow smaller, an easement or utility you cannot move, or no crane or truck access at any reasonable cost. Caution: long utility runs, sloped sites, tight crane reach, HOA unknowns. Rules and prices change, so confirm with your city and in writing. Planning checklist, not legal advice.

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